Card Scheme Rules Summary (Internal)

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1. Important Notice

This is an internal, generic summary prepared by card_ops for operational awareness. It is not the official scheme rulebook. Visa and Mastercard rules change; staff must always consult the current published network rules and the Scheme Relations Manager before acting on a specific case. Where this summary and the official rules differ, the official rules prevail.

2. Authorization Hold Durations

Merchant category	Typical hold	Notes
Standard retail	Up to 7 days	Released on clearing or expiry
Hotels and car rental	Up to 31 days	Hold may exceed final bill; release on final settlement
Fuel (pre-authorisation)	Up to 2 hours	Adjusted to actual amount on completion
Restaurants	Up to 7 days	Tip adjustment tolerance of 20%
Online travel and airlines	Up to 7 days	Cleared at ticket issuance

If a cleared amount is not received within the hold period, Aspire Core releases the hold automatically. Cardholders asking about holds should be told that releases can take up to 7 business days to appear on statements.

3. Cross-Border Fees and Currency Handling

• A cross-border transaction is one where the merchant country differs from the Singapore issuing country.

• Scheme assessments and currency conversion are passed on to the customer under the Aspire fee schedule: foreign exchange margin of 0.8% above the network rate plus a 0.5% cross-border fee for non-SGD merchant settlement.

• Dynamic currency conversion (DCC) is offered by merchants; Aspire recommends customers pay in local currency. DCC disputes are limited to cases where no choice was offered.

• Fees on refunds are not reversed by the network; Aspire credits the margin only for disputes won.

4. Liability Shift

• Chip and PIN: if a counterfeit chip card is accepted at a non-chip terminal, liability generally shifts to the acquirer.

• 3-D Secure: for fully authenticated online transactions, fraud liability generally shifts to the issuer. Attempted-authentication transactions may keep liability with the issuer or merchant depending on network and region.

• Merchants not supporting 3DS bear liability for fraud chargebacks in most regions, supporting representment.

• Aspire step-up policy (see Fraud Rules Playbook) therefore also protects Aspire's chargeback position.

5. Reporting Deadlines

Report	Deadline
Fraud reporting to the scheme (per transaction)	Within 60 days of the transaction or 30 days after detection
Network outage or processing incident notification	Within 4 hours of detection
Data compromise event notification	Within 24 hours of confirmation
Quarterly fraud and chargeback ratio filing	Within 15 days after quarter end
Chargeback monitoring programme threshold	Chargeback ratio above 0.9% with 100+ chargebacks in a month triggers a scheme review

6. Settlement and Interchange

Settlement with the networks is daily in USD and SGD, T+1 for domestic transactions. Interchange is received by the issuer on purchases; the average blended rate in the card programme is approximately 1.4% for consumer-grade and 1.9% for commercial cards, subject to rate-table changes. Interchange figures here are indicative only and must not be shared externally.

7. Escalation

For rule interpretation, contact the Scheme Relations Manager (fictional: Alvin Sng) via Aspire Hub channel #card-schemes. Urgent compliance issues are escalated to the Head of Card Operations.